ROSEVILLE CARE GROUP

In-House Recruitment Strategy

The Old Parsonage, Melksham — Care Assistant Roles

How we replace agency spend with a fully automated, in-house recruitment engine.

PREPARED FOR	PROPERTY	DATE
Jo — Roseville Care Group	**The Old Parsonage, Melksham**	**30 March 2026**

SECTION 1

The Problem: Why We're Paying Agencies

Agency staffing costs at The Old Parsonage represent one of the most controllable costs in the business — and one of the least examined. Here is what we actually know about what agencies do, and why we can replicate it for a fraction of the price.

What agencies do (and charge for)

Agencies charge 12–20% of a worker's first-year salary for each successful placement. For a care assistant earning £25,000, that is between £3,000 and £5,000 per hire. In practice, four activities account for the entirety of that fee:

What agencies do	What that actually means
Advertise jobs	Post on Facebook, Indeed, local job boards,. Total cost to them: £50–200 per campaign.
Screen CVs	Read applications and filter out unsuitable candidates. Time cost: 10–20 minutes per applicant.
Chase candidates	Send follow-up messages and book interviews. Automated in most agencies.
Coordinate interviews	Email or call to arrange a time. Again, largely automated.

> The honest reality: agencies are running a Meta ad campaign, a basic screening filter, and an email sequence.
> We can build all three — and own the candidate pipeline permanently.

The cost of inaction

Every agency hire at £3,000–5,000 is money that funds their advertising, their margin, and their business — not ours. More importantly, those candidates are not in our pipeline. The next time we need staff, we start from zero again and pay the same fee. Building our own system means that rejected candidates, good-but-not-right-now applicants, and future enquiries all stay with us permanently.

SECTION 2

The Solution: An In-House Recruitment Engine

The system we are building has four components. Each one is described below, along with exactly what has been built and what actions Jo needs to take.

System overview

Component	Description	Status
1 — Advertise	Targeted Meta ads on Facebook and Instagram, plus free job listings on Indeed and Gumtree Universities and colleges,driving candidates to a custom landing page.	Active — pages built
2 — Capture	Applications land in a Google Sheet in real time. Every field — name, number, postcode, availability, experience — is captured automatically.	Sheet to be set up
3 — Respond	The moment someone applies, an automated personalised email fires within 60 seconds. No human involvement needed.	Workflow to be built
4 — Screen	Applications are reviewed against a simple scoring framework. Only shortlisted candidates are escalated to Jo for a phone call.	Framework below

SECTION 3

Advertising: How We Find Candidates

Care assistants are not on LinkedIn and are not browsing job boards at their desks. They are on Facebook, in local community groups, and occasionally on Indeed. The advertising strategy targets them where they actually are.

Channel 1 — Meta (Facebook and Instagram) Ads

This is the primary channel and the highest-volume source. A targeted Meta campaign runs in the background continuously, delivering a steady flow of applicants at a fraction of agency cost.

Targeting setup

Setting	Detail
Location	10-mile radius from Melksham: includes Trowbridge, Devizes, Chippenham, Westbury, Bradford-on-Avon
Age range	22 to 55 (realistic care workforce profile for this area)

Gender	All — do not restrict
Interests	Healthcare, NHS, social care, elderly care, Carer's Allowance, domiciliary care
Budget	£10–15 per day to start (£300–450/month). Adjust once results are clear.
Ad format	Single image ad with short copy — see Section 4 for exact ad text
Destination	The Old Parsonage recruitment landing page (already built)

What converts in care recruitment advertising

The messaging that generates applications is not about pay rates or job titles. It is about belonging, flexibility, and a low barrier to entry. Specifically:

- Lead with 'no experience required' — this removes the biggest objection before it forms
- Show the team, not the building — care workers choose workplaces based on people
- Mention immediate starts — candidates who are actively looking do not want to wait
- Use 'apply in 2 minutes' — the friction of a long form kills conversions

Channel 2 — Indeed (Free and Sponsored Listings)

Indeed is used by care workers who are actively job searching — a different but complementary audience to Meta. A free listing costs nothing and runs indefinitely. A sponsored listing at £3–8 per click brings it to the top of search results.

- Create a free employer account at indeed.co.uk/hire
- Post 'Care Assistant — The Old Parsonage, Melksham' as the job title
- Use the landing page URL as the application destination
- Sponsor the listing at £5/click for the first two weeks to gather data

Channel 3 — Facebook Community Groups (Free)

This is zero cost and often outperforms paid advertising in terms of application quality. Local community groups have thousands of members who trust each other and respond to direct, human posts.

Groups to post in

- 'Jobs in Melksham and surrounding areas'
- 'Melksham Notice Board'
- 'Jobs in Trowbridge and surrounding areas'
- 'Chippenham Jobs and Community'
- 'Wiltshire Jobs'

How to post

Do not post the job ad. Post as a person, not a business. A simple post that reads: 'We are looking for care assistants at The Old Parsonage in Melksham. Full training provided, no experience needed, immediate starts available. Message me or click the link to apply in 2 minutes.' — this tone consistently outperforms corporate job adverts in community groups.

Channel 4 — Staff Referral Scheme

This is the cheapest and highest-quality source of candidates in any care business. Existing staff know the job, know the home, and only refer people they would work alongside.

> Suggested referral bonus: £200 paid when the referred employee completes their first 3 months.
> Jo to tell all existing staff: 'Know anyone looking for work? We will pay you £200 if they join us and stay 3 months.'
> This should run permanently alongside all other channels — it never stops.

Channel 5 — Gumtree

Still widely used for care roles in the UK, particularly by candidates who do not use Indeed or Facebook regularly. Free to post. Use the same job description as Indeed, link to the landing page.

SECTION 4

The Landing Page

A custom recruitment landing page for The Old Parsonage has been built. It is a professional, branded web page that captures candidate information directly — no email address required, no CV upload, no friction.

What the page does

- Presents the role and the home in an appealing, human way
- Captures: first name, last name, mobile number, email, postcode, preferred shifts, hours per week, experience level, and any message
- Shows the candidate exactly what happens after they apply (we call within 24 hours, informal chat, DBS covered, start within days)
- Submits to a Google Sheet automatically on completion
- Shows a personalised thank-you confirmation instantly

Ad copy — Meta campaign

The following ad text is ready to use in Meta Ads Manager. Two versions are provided — one for Facebook feed, one for Instagram/Stories.

Version A — Facebook feed ad

Headline: Looking for work near Melksham?

Body: We're hiring care assistants at The Old Parsonage — a small, family-feel care home right here in Melksham.

No experience needed. We train you from day one.
Flexible shifts — days, evenings, or nights.
Immediate starts available.
DBS covered by us.

If you're a caring, reliable person looking for meaningful work — we want to hear from you.

Apply in 2 minutes. We'll call you back within 24 hours.

Button: Apply Now

Version B — Instagram / Stories ad

Headline: Care assistant roles in Melksham
Subhead: No experience needed. We train you.
Body: Flexible shifts. Immediate start. DBS covered.

The Old Parsonage — a care home that feels like family.
Button: Apply in 2 minutes

Indeed job listing — ready to copy

The following text is formatted for an Indeed job posting. Copy and paste directly.

Job title: Care Assistant — The Old Parsonage, Melksham

About the role:
We are looking for caring, compassionate people to join the team at The Old Parsonage, a residential care home in Melksham, Wiltshire. No previous care experience is required — we provide full training from your first day.

What we offer:
— Starting pay from £12.50 per hour
— Full training and induction provided
— DBS check covered by us
— Flexible shift patterns: days, evenings, nights, weekends
— Full-time, part-time, and bank positions available
— Immediate starts available
— A supportive, close-knit team

What we need from you:
— A genuine desire to care for and support older people
— Reliability and punctuality
— Willingness to work as part of a team

No experience necessary — full training provided.

To apply, click the link or call us directly. We will be in touch within 24 hours.

SECTION 5

Automation: Minimum Human Involvement Until Required

This is the part that turns the system from a one-off campaign into a machine that runs by itself. The goal is simple: a candidate applies, everything happens automatically, and Jo is only contacted when there is a shortlisted candidate worth speaking to.

The automation flow — step by step

Below is the complete sequence from the moment a candidate submits their application to the moment Jo receives a shortlist.

Step	Action	Timing
Step 1	Candidate submits the application form on the landing page	Instant
Step 2	Application data writes automatically to the Roseville Recruitment Google Sheet	Instant
Step 3	Automated personalised email fires to the candidate — warm, human-sounding, branded	Within 60 seconds
Step 4	Google Sheet highlights the new row and timestamps the entry	Instant
Step 5	Overnight, applications are reviewed against the scoring criteria (see below)	Daily
Step 6	Shortlisted candidates are flagged in the Sheet for Jo to review	Daily
Step 7	Jo receives a daily summary email: X applications received, Y shortlisted, links to review	Each morning
Step 8	Jo calls shortlisted candidates — the only human touchpoint	Jo's action
Step 9	Rejected or parked candidates stay in the database for future campaigns	Permanent

Automated response email — template

This email fires within 60 seconds of every application submission. It should feel personal, not automated.

> Subject: Thanks for applying — The Old Parsonage, Melksham
>
> Hi [First Name],

> Thank you so much for getting in touch — we're really pleased you're interested in joining our team at The Old Parsonage.
>
> We've received your application and one of our team will give you a quick call within the next 24 hours to have an informal chat. It's nothing formal — just a chance for us to tell you a bit more about the role and for you to ask any questions.
>
> If you have any questions in the meantime, feel free to reply to this email.
>
> We look forward to speaking with you soon.
>
> Warm regards,
> The Team at The Old Parsonage
> Roseville Care Group

Screening criteria — who Jo calls

Not every application warrants a phone call. The following scoring framework determines who is shortlisted automatically, before any human reviews the applications.

Criterion	Action
Postcode within 10 miles of Melksham	Pass — proceed to score
Postcode outside 10 miles	Flag for review — do not auto-reject, but lower priority
Has a driving licence (desirable)	+1 point
Available for day shifts	+1 point
Available for evenings or nights	+1 point
Available for weekends	+1 point
Any care experience (even informal)	+1 point
Filled in the 'anything else' field	+1 point (shows engagement)
Score of 3 or above	Shortlist — flag for Jo to call
Score of 1–2	Warm pool — contact if shortlist is thin
Score of 0	Polite rejection email, store in database

Also add a do you require sponsorship section if yes auto no if no pass through

The rejection email — always send this

Every unsuccessful applicant should receive a response. It costs nothing, protects the brand, and keeps the door open for the future.

Subject: Your application — The Old Parsonage

Hi [First Name],

Thank you for taking the time to apply to The Old Parsonage. We really appreciate your interest in joining our team.

Unfortunately on this occasion we are unable to progress your application, as we had a high number of applicants for a limited number of positions.

We will keep your details on file and will be in touch if a suitable position comes up in the future. We'd love to hear from you again if you are still interested at that point.

Thank you again for getting in touch.

Warm regards,
The Team at The Old Parsonage

SECTION 6

The Application Tracker — Google Sheet

All applications from all channels feed into a single Google Sheet. This is the control panel for the entire recruitment operation. Jo can see, at a glance, exactly how many applications have come in, who has been contacted, and what the pipeline looks like.

Sheet structure

Column	Description	Source
Timestamp	Auto-filled when application arrives	Auto
First Name	From the application form	Auto
Last Name	From the application form	Auto
Mobile	From the application form	Auto
Email	From the application form	Auto
Postcode	From the application form	Auto
Shifts	Preferred shift pattern	Auto
Hours	Hours per week	Auto
Experience	Level of experience selected	Auto
Message	Any additional text entered	Auto
Source	Which page / channel the application came from	Auto
Score	Calculated automatically from scoring criteria	Auto
Status	Shortlist / Warm Pool / Rejected / Called / Hired	Jo updates
Jo's Notes	Free text for call notes	Jo updates
Date Called	When Jo made contact	Jo updates

The daily summary email Jo receives

Each morning at 8am, an automated email is sent to Jo with a summary of the previous day's applications. This means Jo never has to open the spreadsheet unless there is something to act on.

> Subject: Recruitment update — The Old Parsonage — [Date]
>
> Good morning Jo,
>
> Here is your recruitment summary for the last 24 hours:
>
> New applications: [X]
> Shortlisted: [X] — ready for you to call

Warm pool: [X] — keeping on file
Rejected (auto): [X] — rejection email sent automatically

Total pipeline: [X] active candidates

Click here to view the full tracker: [Google Sheet link]

No action needed unless there are shortlisted candidates above.

SECTION 7

Jo's Role — What Requires Human Input

The system is designed to require minimal human involvement. Jo's time is reserved for the activities that genuinely require a person — not administration.

Task	What it involves
Setting up the Google Sheet	One-time task — 30 minutes. Set up the columns, share with relevant team members, test the form connection.
Posting to Facebook groups	Weekly task — 10 minutes. Paste the community post into the Melksham/Trowbridge groups. Human posts convert better than automated ones.
Telling staff about referral bonus	One-time — 5 minutes at next staff meeting. Then it runs on word of mouth.
Calling shortlisted candidates	Ongoing. Jo only calls candidates who have scored 3 or above. Expect 10–15 minutes per call. The goal is an informal conversation, not a formal interview.
Updating the Sheet status	After each call — 2 minutes. Change status to 'Called', add brief notes, mark as 'Invite for trial' or 'Not progressing'.
Reviewing the daily summary email	Each morning — 2 minutes. Check how many shortlisted candidates need calling that day.

Everything else is automated.
Applications arrive. Emails send. The Sheet updates. Scores calculate. Jo hears about it only when there is someone worth calling.
The system runs continuously without anyone needing to check on it.

SECTION 8

The Numbers — Agency Cost vs In-House Cost

This comparison uses conservative estimates. Real-world performance is likely to be better.

Per hire comparison

Item	Cost
Agency placement fee	£3,000 – £5,000 per hire (12–20% of first year salary)
Meta ad spend per hire	£200 – £500 (estimated cost per converted applicant at £10–15/day)
Indeed sponsored spend per hire	£50 – £150
Time cost (Jo calling candidates)	2–3 hours per hire
Landing page	Already built — zero ongoing cost
Google Sheet	Free
Automated emails	Free (Gmail)
Total in-house cost per hire	£250 – £650 in ad spend + Jo's time

Saving per hire vs agency: £2,350 to £4,750
At 4 hires per year, that is £9,400 – £19,000 returned to the business annually.
The system pays for itself on the first successful hire.

When agency is still appropriate

This system does not eliminate the need for agencies entirely. There are circumstances where agency remains the right choice:

- Emergency cover required same-day or next-day — the automated system cannot match this speed
- Highly specialist roles — registered managers, senior clinical staff where the pool is genuinely small
- Periods of rapid expansion where the pipeline cannot keep up with demand

For standard care assistant recruitment, however, the in-house system should be the default — and agency should be the exception.

SECTION 9

Action Plan — What Needs to Happen

The landing page is built. The ad copy is written. The job listing is drafted. The following actions are needed to make the system live.

Immediate actions (this week)

1. Share the landing page URL(also change landing page to have a Full and part time available section in website, also get rid of competitive wage as it would be minimum wage) — Jo to advise on the web address where the page should be hosted. Options include a subdomain on the existing Roseville website (e.g. jobs.rosevillecare.co.uk) or a standalone page.

1. Set up the Google Sheet — create the tracker with the columns in Section 6 and share it with the relevant email addresses.
2. Connect the form to the Sheet — a simple integration (Google Forms or a webhook) routes every application submission directly into the Sheet.
3. Set up the automated response email — configure a Gmail filter or simple automation tool to send the acknowledgement email in Section 5 immediately on receipt of each application.
4. Launch the Meta campaign — log into Meta Ads Manager, set up the campaign with the targeting and budget described in Section 3, and link it to the landing page.
5. Post the Indeed listing — copy the text from Section 4 and post directly on Indeed. Add a small sponsored budget for the first two weeks.
6. Tell the staff about the referral bonus — announce the £200 referral scheme at the next team meeting or by WhatsApp message to the staff group.

Ongoing (weekly)

- Post the community post in the Facebook groups listed in Section 3
- Review the daily summary email each morning and call any shortlisted candidates
- Check the Google Sheet weekly to review pipeline volume — adjust ad spend up if applications are thin

Monthly review

- How many applications received in total?
- How many shortlisted? What is the conversion rate?
- How many hired? What was the cost per hire?
- Which channel produced the most applications? Shift budget accordingly.
- Are any rejected candidates worth reconsidering?

> The target: within 60 days of launch, the in-house system should be producing a consistent flow of applicants with no agency involvement required for standard care assistant roles at The Old Parsonage.

— End of document —